

Sol-fa

Level 1





About the Course

March, imitate, and play games with music. Explore how simple melodic patterns and rhythms build into scales. Finish with an understanding of dynamics, basic rhythms, and the sol-fa scale. Audio lessons are provided with the lesson plans.

Skill Focus: Rhythm, melody, scales, dynamics, and sol-fa syllables ("do" - "so").

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Level 1



Placement & Combining Tips

Grade 3 students with no experience with sol-fa or sight-reading music may start with Level 1.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2+	Sol-fa: Level 1 1 time/week 10 min	Sol-fa Level 1 Audio Lessons

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Level 1				
Sol-fa: Level 1	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Composer Study



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Sol-fa: Level 1

☐ Bookmark Sol-fa playlists (see Quick Links). If you create a free account on the SoundCloud app, the Sol-Fa lessons become downloadable for offline use.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Sol-fa: Level 1



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



Sol-fa Level 1 Audio Lessons



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Sol-fa: Level 1

∞ [Sol-fa SoundCloud Playlist](#)

∞ [Warm-Ups](#)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Sol-fa: Level 1

How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you

add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 1 Humming, Lip Trills, Steady Beats → INTRO We're going to start learning how to sight-sing this term. Eventually, we'll be reading music, but first, we need to train our ears! As you work on singing melodies and rhythms, notice how your sol-fa lessons can help you sing your hymns or folk songs. → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 1	
WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 2 Rhythms → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 2	
WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 3 Rhythms (cont.) → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 3	
WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 4 Rhythms (cont.) → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 4	
WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 5 Pitch → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 5	



Term 1	
WEEK 6 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 6 High and Low Pitches → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 6	
WEEK 7 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 7 Rhythmic Patterns → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 7	
WEEK 8 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 8 Melodic Patterns → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 8	
WEEK 9 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 9 Melodic and Rhythmic Patterns (cont.) → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 9	
WEEK 10 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 10 Melodic and Rhythmic Patterns (cont.) → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 10	

Term 1	
WEEK 11 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 11 Melodic and Rhythmic Patterns (cont.)	
→ RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups	
→ LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 11	
WEEK 12 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 12 Exam Week	
→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
Questions will come from: Sol-fa Level 1 Coursework	

→ RECAP

Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Lesson 11



Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 13
Melodies with the Piano

- RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 12

WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 14
Musical Emotions

- RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 13

WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 15
Dynamics

- RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 14

WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 16
Legato and Staccato

- RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 15

WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 17
Dynamics, Rhythms, and Emotional Effects

- RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 16



Term 2

WEEK 6 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 18 <i>Crescendos and Decrescendos</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 17	
WEEK 7 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 19 <i>Comb. Rhythms, Melodies, Dynamics</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 18	
WEEK 8 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 20 <i>Vocal Exercises</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 19	
WEEK 9 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 21 <i>Intervals</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 20	
WEEK 10 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 22 <i>Rhythmic and Melodic Patterns (cont.)</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 21	



Term 2

WEEK 11 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 23 <i>Rhythmic and Melodic Patterns (cont.)</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 22	
WEEK 12 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Sol-fa Level 1 Coursework	



Term 3

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 25
Introduction to Sol-fa Signs

- **RECAP**
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- **LISTEN & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 23
- **VIEW**
∞ Image Link: Curwen Hand Signs

WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 26
Do, Re, Mi

- **RECAP**
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- **LISTEN & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 24

WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 27
Singing Do, Re, & Mi

- **RECAP**
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- **LISTEN & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 25

WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 28
Musical Patterns with Do, Re, & Mi

- **RECAP**
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- **LISTEN & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 26

WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 29
Pentatonic Scale

- **RECAP**
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups
- **LISTEN & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 27



Term 3

WEEK 6 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 30 <i>Hand Signs for Fa & So</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 28	
WEEK 7 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 31 <i>Intervals with Pentatonic Scale</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 29	
WEEK 8 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 32 <i>Quarter Notes</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → VIEW & PRACTICE ∞ Video Link: How to Draw a Quarter Note → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 30	
WEEK 9 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 33 <i>Sol-fa with Quarter Notes</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 31	
WEEK 10 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 34 <i>Intervals (cont.)</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 32	



Term 3

WEEK 11 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 35
Recap

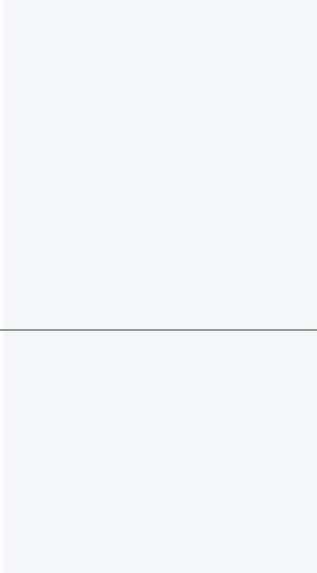
→ **RECAP**
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ **LISTEN & PRACTICE**
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 33

WEEK 12 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 36
Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**
Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: Sol-fa Level 1 Coursework



Sol-fa: Level 1

Examination

Term 1

· The teacher should clap and have the student imitate the following rhythms: (The quick claps should be about twice as fast as the slow claps.)

1) slow, slow, quick, quick, slow

2) quick, quick, slow, slow, quick, quick

Term 2

· Sing a few notes that are piano, then sing a few notes forte. OR Sing a few notes that are legato and a few notes that are staccato. (Note to teacher: Piano means “soft,” forte means “loud,” legato means “fluid/smooth/connected,” and staccato means “sharp/separated.”)

Term 3

· Sing the following Sol-fa patterns with your hand signs:

1) do-re-mi-fa-so

2) do-mi-so-mi-do